

TIMELINE

- **February 8, 1820** Born William Tecumseh Sherman in Lancaster, Ohio, the third son of Charles and Mary. After the death of his father he is reared by Senator Thomas Ewing, a family friend.
- **Summer 1840** Sherman graduates from West Point. As a second lieutenant in the artillery, he is soon battling the Seminole Indians in Florida during the Second Seminole War (1835-42).
- **May 1, 1850** Marries his stepsister, Eleanor Boyle Ewing. President Zachary Taylor is a guest.
- **September 6, 1853** Resigns from the army but remains restless and unhappy in various jobs.
- **May 1861** Sherman rejoins the U.S. Army.
- **July 5, 1861** His daughter Rachel, the first of eight children, is born.



SHERMAN AND HIS DAUGHTER RACHEL

- **July 21, 1861** As colonel in charge of a brigade, he distinguishes himself at the First Battle of Bull Run (Manassas) and is promoted to brigadier general.
- **November 1861** After two months in charge of the Department of the Cumberland, covering most of Kentucky, Sherman asks to be relieved following a nervous breakdown.